

Nigerian Diet Guide for Multi-Morbidity Management

Abuja, Nigeria — May 2026

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Disclaimer: This guide is for educational purposes only. Always consult your doctor or dietitian for personalised advice based on your lab results.

1. Diabetes + Hypertension

FOODS TO EAT / RECOMMENDED		
Category	Food	Why It Helps
Swallows	Unripe Plantain (boiled/swallow)	Low glycaemic index; resistant starch improves insulin sensitivity; potassium supports blood pressure
Swallows	Oat Swallow (Elkris/oat flour)	Beta-glucan fibre lowers blood sugar AND cholesterol; best swallow alternative
Swallows	Ofada / Brown Rice (small portion)	Higher fibre than white rice; better blood sugar control
Swallows	Moi Moi (steamed bean pudding)	High protein, low fat, low sugar; excellent for both conditions
Swallows	Guinea Corn (Sorghum) Fufu	More fibre than eba or pounded yam; complex carbohydrate
Swallows	Wheat Fufu	Lower glycaemic load than cassava swallows
Soups	Efo Riro (little palm oil)	Packed with leafy greens, vitamins, minerals; anti-inflammatory
Soups	Bitter Leaf Soup (Ofe Onugbu)	Reduces LDL cholesterol by up to 50%; anti-diabetic; heart-protective
Soups	Okra Soup (draw soup, little oil)	Fibre & mucilage lower cholesterol and stabilise blood sugar
Soups	Ogbono Soup	Rich in fibre; slows glucose absorption
Soups	Egusi Soup (minimal palm oil)	Unsaturated fats, plant protein, zinc, magnesium; healthy in small oil
Soups	Oha Soup	Traditional leafy green soup; naturally low in sugar
Soups	Pepper Soup (fish/chicken, no offal)	Low calorie, high protein; spices help regulate blood pressure
Soups	Edikaikong (less oil)	Powerhouse of ugu + waterleaf; high fibre, vitamins
Proteins	Grilled/boiled fish (tilapia, titus, catfish)	Omega-3 fatty acids lower blood pressure and blood fats
Proteins	Beans (ewa, black-eyed peas — boiled, not fried)	High fibre and plant protein; slows blood sugar absorption
Proteins	Chicken/Turkey (skinless, boiled/grilled)	Lean protein with low saturated fat
Proteins	Egg whites	High quality protein; less cholesterol than yolk
Vegetables	Ugwu (Fluted Pumpkin Leaves)	Regulates blood glucose; lowers blood pressure via potassium and nitrate

1. Diabetes + Hypertension

Vegetables	Bitter Leaf	Anti-diabetic; detoxifies; reduces cholesterol
Vegetables	Garden Egg (African Eggplant)	Inhibits enzymes linked to Type 2 diabetes; reduces LDL; high fibre
Vegetables	Waterleaf	High antioxidants; diuretic properties help blood pressure
Vegetables	Tatashe (Red Bell Pepper)	Rich in Vitamin C and antioxidants; relatively low in potassium
Vegetables	Onions & Garlic	Natural sodium alternative; anti-inflammatory; heart-protective
Vegetables	Cabbage	Low calorie, high fibre; low potassium; supports blood sugar control
Vegetables	Cucumber	Low calorie; hydrating; low glycaemic index
Vegetables	Scent Leaf (Efirin/Nchuanwu)	Traditional blood pressure and blood sugar regulator
Fruits	Unripe/Semi-ripe Plantain	Low sugar; complex carbs
Fruits	Avocado	Healthy monounsaturated fats; lowers LDL; heart-protective
Fruits	Guava	High fibre and Vitamin C; low glycaemic index; supports blood pressure
Fruits	Pawpaw (moderate portions)	Rich in antioxidants; moderate glycaemic — portion-controlled
Fruits	Watermelon (small portions)	Hydrating; antioxidants; limit due to sugar content in diabetes
Drinks	Zobo (Hibiscus tea, unsweetened)	Clinically proven to lower blood pressure; reduces cholesterol; anti-diabetic
Drinks	Akamu/Pap (unsweetened)	Low-GI breakfast option with no added sugar
Drinks	Tiger Nut Milk (unsweetened)	Healthy fats; low GI
Drinks	Water (8–10 glasses daily)	Essential hydration

FOODS TO AVOID

Food to Avoid	Reason
Eba/Garri (large portions)	Very high refined carbohydrates; rapid blood sugar spike
Pounded Yam (large portions)	High glycaemic index when eaten in large quantities

1. Diabetes + Hypertension

White Rice (large portions)	Low fibre; rapid blood sugar elevation
Ripe Plantain / Fried Plantain (dodo)	High sugar; fried version adds unhealthy fat
Fried Foods (fried yam, plantain, excess oil)	High in unhealthy fats; contributes to insulin resistance
Seasoning Cubes (Maggi, Knorr)	Extremely high sodium; major contributor to hypertension
Smoked/Dried Fish (large amounts)	Very high in sodium
Stockfish	High sodium and phosphorus
Sugar-sweetened beverages (soft drinks)	High fructose; insulin resistance; increases blood pressure
White Bread, Pastries, Cakes	Refined flour; rapid blood sugar spike; high in saturated fat
Organ Meats (liver, stomach, intestines) in	High in saturated fat and cholesterol
Palm Oil (excess)	High in saturated fat; raises LDL cholesterol
Alcohol	Raises blood pressure; interferes with blood sugar control

2. Hypertension + CKD

CKD Stage Note: Potassium & phosphorus restrictions depend on CKD stage and lab values. Always confirm with your doctor before following this list.

FOODS TO EAT / RECOMMENDED		
Category	Food	Why It Helps
Staples	White Rice (small portions, unsalted)	Lower potassium than brown rice; kidney-friendlier carb
Staples	White Semovita (small portion)	Easier on kidneys than whole-grain alternatives
Staples	Soft Pap/Akamu (no excess sugar or salt)	Gentle on kidneys; hydrating
Proteins	Grilled/boiled fish (tilapia, sardines)	Omega-3s lower blood pressure; high quality protein in moderate portions
Proteins	Ofe Nsala (White Soup) with fish or chicken	Light soup; low calorie; good for fluid management
Proteins	Egg whites (not whole eggs)	High quality protein with less phosphorus than yolks or meat
Proteins	Skinless chicken/turkey (boiled, small portions)	Moderate protein; lower sodium if fresh
Proteins	Pepper soup (fish-based, no added salt)	Blood pressure regulation; low fat; avoid organ meats
Vegetables	Cabbage (raw or boiled)	Low potassium; low sodium; packed with Vitamin K and C; kidney-friendly
Vegetables	Tatashe / Red Bell Pepper	Low potassium; rich in antioxidants; kidney-protective
Vegetables	Onions	Low potassium; flavonoids protect against kidney damage
Vegetables	Garlic	Replaces salt; natural anti-inflammatory; kidney-protective
Vegetables	Green Beans	Low potassium; high fibre
Vegetables	Carrots (boiled)	Lower potassium when boiled; antioxidants
Vegetables	Cucumber	Very hydrating; low potassium; diuretic
Vegetables	Garden Egg	Low sodium; diuretic; helps lower blood pressure
Fruits	Apples	Low potassium; high fibre; reduces cholesterol; kidney-friendly
Fruits	Strawberries	Low potassium; rich in antioxidants; heart and kidney protective

2. Hypertension + CKD

CKD Stage Note: Potassium & phosphorus restrictions depend on CKD stage and lab values. Always confirm with your doctor before following this list.

Fruits	Pineapple	Lower potassium than most tropical fruits; anti-inflammatory
Fruits	Grapes	Low potassium; antioxidant-rich; kidney-friendly
Fruits	Blueberries/Blackberries	Low potassium; powerful antioxidants
Fruits	Watermelon (small portions)	Helps kidneys flush toxins; hydrating — watch fluid limits in advanced CKD
Drinks	Zobo (unsweetened)	Improves kidney ability to filter uric acid and oxalic acid; lowers blood pressure
Drinks	Plain Water (8–10 glasses)	Essential for kidney function — adjust based on fluid restrictions

FOODS TO AVOID

Food to Avoid	Reason
Bananas	Very high potassium — dangerous for damaged kidneys
Pawpaw (Papaya)	High potassium; must avoid in CKD
Avocados	Extremely high potassium despite being heart-healthy
Oranges & Orange Juice	High potassium; replace with apple or grape juice
Mangoes	High potassium and sugar
Tomatoes (cooked/paste, large amounts)	High potassium — tomato paste is especially concentrated
Ugwu/Spinach (cooked, large amounts)	High potassium when cooked; moderate use only or leach before cooking
Sweet Potatoes	High potassium; avoid or leach
Dried Beans/Cowpeas (large amounts)	High potassium and phosphorus
Dairy (milk, cheese, yogurt, cream)	High phosphorus and potassium; weakens bones when kidneys fail
Crayfish	Very high in phosphorus and sodium
Iru (Ogiri / fermented bean paste)	High phosphorus; avoid in CKD

2. Hypertension + CKD

CKD Stage Note: Potassium & phosphorus restrictions depend on CKD stage and lab values. Always confirm with your doctor before following this list.

Stockfish & Smoked Fish	Very high sodium; strains kidneys
Seasoning Cubes (Maggi, Knorr)	Extreme sodium content; replace with garlic, ginger, onion
Soft Drinks / Dark Cola	Phosphorus additives damage kidneys and weaken bones
Canned Foods	High sodium preservatives
Processed Meats (sausage, canned beef)	High sodium, phosphorus, and nitrates

3. Triple (DM+HTN+CKD)

Most demanding combination. Diet must be: low sugar, low sodium, low potassium (check labs), low phosphorus, moderate protein, high fibre. Consult your dietitian.

FOODS TO EAT / RECOMMENDED

Category	Food	Why It Helps
Swallows	Oat Swallow (unsalted, small portion)	Best swallow — controls blood sugar + lower potassium than unripe plantain
Swallows	White Rice (tiny portion + lots of vegetables)	Lower potassium than brown rice for CKD; manageable glycaemic with vegetable content
Proteins	Grilled/boiled fresh tilapia or catfish (small portion)	Best protein for all three conditions — omega-3s, moderate purines
Proteins	Egg whites (not yolk)	Excellent quality protein, low phosphorus, low purine
Proteins	Skinless boiled chicken (small portion, no seasoning cube)	Moderate protein; avoid adding salt or seasoning cube
Soups	Pepper Soup (fish-based, no salt, no Maggi or effee)	Ideal meal — low fat, blood pressure regulating
Soups	Cabbage soup/stew	Low potassium; kidney-friendly vegetable
Soups	Garden Egg Sauce	Low sodium, anti-diabetic, cholesterol-lowering
Fruits	Apples	Safe for all three — low potassium, low glycaemic, kidney-friendly
Fruits	Pineapple (small portion)	Lower potassium tropical fruit; safe for kidneys
Fruits	Strawberries	Low potassium, low sugar, antioxidant-rich
Fruits	Grapes (small handful)	Low potassium; blood sugar friendly
Drinks	Unsweetened Zobo	Lowers blood pressure; supports kidney filtration; reduces blood sugar
Drinks	Plain Water (8–10 glasses)	Universal kidney protector; adjust if fluid-restricted

FOODS TO AVOID

Food to Avoid	Reason
Seasoning Cubes (Maggi, Knorr)	Sodium overload — damages kidneys and raises blood pressure

3. Triple (DM+HTN+CKD)

Most demanding combination. Diet must be: low sugar, low sodium, low potassium (check labs), low phosphorus, moderate protein, high fibre. Consult your dietitian.

Bananas, Pawpaw, Oranges, Mangoes	High potassium — dangerous for CKD kidneys
Avocado	Very high potassium
Sweetened drinks, soft drinks, milk	High sugar + phosphorus additives
Eba (large portions)	High refined carbs — blood sugar spike
Pounded Yam (large portions)	High GI; high potassium
Stockfish, Crayfish, Iru	High phosphorus + sodium
Organ meats (liver, kidney, stomach)	High phosphorus, uric acid, cholesterol
Dairy products in excess (milk, cheese)	High phosphorus and potassium
Ripe Plantain / Dodo (fried)	High sugar and unhealthy fats
Smoked / Dried Fish	Very high in sodium and phosphorus

GENERAL PRINCIPLES FOR TRIPLE COMBINATION

- Carbohydrates: Small portions, lowest glycaemic load — Oat Swallow > White Rice > Pounded Yam (avoid large amounts of any)
- Protein: Moderate intake — Fresh fish > Skinless chicken/turkey > Egg whites; limit red meat and offals
- Salt: None — no seasoning cubes; flavour with fresh onions, ginger, garlic, scent leaf, uziza
- Oil: Minimal — 1–2 tablespoons of vegetable/olive oil per pot; less palm oil
- Avoid crayfish, stockfish, dried fish — all very high in sodium and phosphorus

4. High Uric Acid (Gout)

Note: Spinach, mushrooms, cauliflower, and green peas are MODERATE-purine — can be eaten in small amounts but not daily in large quantities.

FOODS TO EAT / RECOMMENDED		
Category	Food	Why It Helps
Staples	Boiled White Rice	Very low in purines
Staples	Yam (boiled, small portion)	Low purine content
Staples	Unripe Plantain	Low purine; complex carbs
Staples	Pasta/Noodles (plain)	Low purine carb option
Staples	Moi Moi	Bean-based but beans have NOT been shown to trigger gout attacks
Proteins	Egg whites	Very low purine; safe protein source
Proteins	Beans and lentils	Uric acid neutral; protective against gout attacks
Proteins	Fresh tilapia (not sardines/mackerel)	Moderate purine; safer fish than oily fish
Proteins	Low-fat dairy (small amounts)	Certain proteins help the body excrete uric acid
Vegetables	Tomatoes	Anti-inflammatory; low purine; Vitamin C lowers uric acid
Vegetables	Cabbage	Very low purine; anti-inflammatory
Vegetables	Cucumber	Hydrating; flushes uric acid; low purine
Vegetables	Garden Egg	Low purine; anti-inflammatory
Vegetables	Tatashe / Bell Peppers	Low purine; rich in Vitamin C
Vegetables	Carrots	Very low purine; antioxidant-rich
Vegetables	Onions and Garlic	Anti-inflammatory; low purine
Fruits	Cherries	#1 gout fruit — anthocyanins reduce uric acid and inflammation
Fruits	Oranges & Lemons	Vitamin C lowers uric acid; citric acid helps flush it out

4. High Uric Acid (Gout)

Note: Spinach, mushrooms, cauliflower, and green peas are MODERATE-purine — can be eaten in small amounts but not daily in large quantities.

Fruits	Strawberries	Vitamin C; anti-inflammatory anthocyanins
Fruits	Pineapples	Vitamin C; bromelain reduces inflammation
Fruits	Apples	Low purine; antioxidants; safe daily fruit
Fruits	Bananas	Very low purine; naturally anti-gout
Fruits	Avocado	Vitamin E; anti-inflammatory — reduces gout flares
Fruits	Watermelon	High water content; flushes uric acid; low purine
Drinks	Water (10–12 glasses daily)	Most important — flushes uric acid through urine
Drinks	Lemon Water	Citric acid neutralises and flushes uric acid
Drinks	Zobo (unsweetened)	Improves kidney filtration of uric acid
Drinks	Green Tea	Shown to lower uric acid production
Drinks	Coffee (plain, no sugar)	Regular intake associated with lower gout risk

FOODS TO AVOID

Food to Avoid	Reason
Organ Meats (liver, kidney, stomach, intestines)	Extremely high purines — the worst triggers for gout
Red Meat (beef, goat, mutton) in large amounts	High in purines; moderate intake only
Sardines, Mackerel (Tilus), Anchovies, Herring	Very high purine fish — major gout triggers
Shellfish (shrimp, crab, lobster, crayfish)	High purine seafood — triggers attacks
Beer and Alcohol	Alcohol blocks uric acid excretion; beer especially high in purines
Sugary drinks and fruit juices	Fructose increases uric acid production
Turkey (large amounts)	Higher purine poultry

4. High Uric Acid (Gout)

Note: Spinach, mushrooms, cauliflower, and green peas are MODERATE-purine — can be eaten in small amounts but not daily in large quantities.

Dried beans and soybeans (large amounts)	High purine legumes (regular beans are safer)
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Goose and Duck	High purine
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Sweetened Zobo / Malt drinks	Fructose in added sugar raises uric acid
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5. High Cholesterol

FOODS TO EAT / RECOMMENDED		
Category	Food	Why It Helps
Staples	Oatmeal / Oat Swallow	Beta-glucan reduces LDL by up to 10%
Staples	Millet (Tuwo Masara)	Fibre-rich; reduces cholesterol absorption
Staples	Beans (Ewa, black-eyed peas, lentils)	Soluble fibre and plant protein lower LDL
Staples	Ofada / Brown Rice	More fibre than white rice; cholesterol-regulating
Soups	Bitter Leaf Soup	Reduces LDL cholesterol by up to 50%; increases HDL
Soups	Efo Riro (minimal oil)	Rich leafy greens; fibre; antioxidants
Soups	Okra Soup (minimal oil)	Mucilage and fibre bind to cholesterol and remove it
Vegetables	Garden Egg	Fibre reduces bad cholesterol; antioxidants protect arteries
Proteins	Mackerel (Titus Fish)	Omega-3s lower triglycerides; raise HDL cholesterol
Proteins	Grilled Chicken/Turkey (skinless)	Lean protein without saturated fat
Proteins	Groundnuts (small handful, unsalted)	Healthy fats; reduces LDL in moderation
Proteins	Walnuts	Omega-3 and polyunsaturated fats; strongly cardioprotective
Fruits	Apples	Pectin fibre binds to cholesterol
Fruits	Avocado	Lowers LDL; raises HDL
Fruits	Pears	High in pectin fibre; cholesterol-lowering
Fruits	Pawpaw	Antioxidants and fibre support heart health (moderate portion)
Fruits	Watermelon	Lycopene reduces LDL oxidation; moderate portion
Fruits	Guava	High fibre; Vitamin C; low glycaemic
Drinks	Zobo (unsweetened)	Reduces both LDL cholesterol and blood pressure

5. High Cholesterol

Drinks

Green Tea

Catechins reduce LDL cholesterol

Drinks

Tiger Nut Milk

Oleic acid; healthy fats; cholesterol-lowering

FOODS TO AVOID

Food to Avoid

Reason

Palm Oil (large amounts)	High in saturated fat; raises LDL cholesterol
Coconut Oil	Highest saturated fat oil; significantly increases LDL
Fried Foods (fried plantain, fried yam, okra, etc.)	Saturated and trans fats raise LDL
Organ Meats (liver, etc.)	Very high in dietary cholesterol
Processed Meats (sausage, cured beef, luncheon)	High in saturated fats and sodium
Butter and Margarine	Saturated and trans fats
Whole Milk, Cheese, Ice Cream	High saturated fat dairy
Egg Yolks (excess)	High dietary cholesterol
Baked Goods (cakes, pastries, doughnuts, etc.)	Saturated and trans fats from butter, margarine, palm oil
Shrimp/Crayfish (large amounts)	High in dietary cholesterol

Universal Safe Foods — ALL Five Conditions Simultaneously

These foods are safe for Diabetes + Hypertension + Kidney Disease + High Uric Acid + High Cholesterol — all at once.

Food	Why It's Safe Across ALL Conditions
Oat Swallow (unsalted)	Low GI (diabetes ✓), lowers cholesterol (✓), low purine (gout ✓), low potassium vs alternatives (CKD ✓), lowers blood pressure (HTN ✓)
Boiled White Rice (small portions, no salt)	Low purine (gout ✓), lower potassium than brown rice (CKD ✓), manageable glycaemic with portion control (diabetes ✓)
Grilled/boiled fresh tilapia or catfish (no salt)	Omega-3s (HTN ✓, cholesterol ✓), moderate purine (gout ✓), good protein for CKD ✓, low saturated fat (diabetes ✓)
Egg whites	Low purine (gout ✓), low phosphorus (CKD ✓), zero cholesterol (✓), lean protein (diabetes ✓, HTN ✓)
Skinless boiled chicken (small, no seasoning cube)	Lean protein; safe for all five when unseasoned and portion-controlled
Cabbage (boiled or raw)	Low potassium (CKD ✓), low purine (gout ✓), high fibre (cholesterol ✓), anti-inflammatory (HTN ✓), low GI (diabetes ✓)
Tatashe / Red Bell Pepper	Low potassium (CKD ✓), low purine (gout ✓), high Vitamin C reduces uric acid (gout ✓), antioxidant-rich
Onions & Garlic	Natural salt substitute (HTN ✓), anti-inflammatory (all ✓), low purine (gout ✓), low potassium (CKD ✓)
Carrots (boiled)	Lower potassium when boiled (CKD ✓), low purine (gout ✓), antioxidant, low GI (diabetes ✓)
Garden Egg	Anti-diabetic (✓), lowers cholesterol (✓), low purine (gout ✓), lowers blood pressure (HTN ✓), low sodium (CKD ✓)
Cucumber	Low purine (gout ✓), low potassium (CKD ✓), hydrating, low GI (diabetes ✓), flushes uric acid (gout ✓)
Apples	Low purine (gout ✓), low potassium (CKD ✓), lowers cholesterol (✓), low GI (diabetes ✓), kidney-friendly (✓)
Strawberries	Low potassium (CKD ✓), low purine (gout ✓), Vitamin C lowers uric acid (gout ✓), antioxidant-rich
Pineapple (small portion)	Low potassium (CKD ✓), Vitamin C (gout ✓), anti-inflammatory, moderate purine — safe in small amounts
Unsweetened Zobo (Hibiscus tea)	Lowers blood pressure (HTN ✓), lowers cholesterol (✓), improves kidney filtration (CKD ✓), anti-diabetic (✓), reduces uric acid accumulation (gout ✓)
Plain Water (8–10 glasses)	Universal kidney protector (CKD ✓) and uric acid flusher (gout ✓); essential for all conditions

Universal Safe Foods — ALL Five Conditions Simultaneously

These foods are safe for Diabetes + Hypertension + Kidney Disease + High Uric Acid + High Cholesterol — all at once.

Pepper Soup — fish-based, NO salt/Maggi/offal

Low fat, blood pressure regulating (HTN ✓), high quality protein (all ✓), no high-purine offal (gout ✓)

Okra Soup (minimal oil, no seasoning cube)

Lowers blood sugar (diabetes ✓), lowers cholesterol (✓), kidney-friendly (CKD ✓), low purine (gout ✓)

Moi Moi (no excess salt, no seasoning cube)

Bean protein, low fat, low GI (diabetes ✓), low purine (gout ✓), kidney-friendly in moderate portions (CKD ✓)

Garden Egg Sauce (garlic/onions/pepper, minimal oil)

Anti-diabetic (✓), lowers cholesterol (✓), blood pressure regulating (HTN ✓), low purine (gout ✓)

Smart Cooking Tips for Multi-Morbidity Management

Apply these preparation techniques to make Nigerian meals safer and healthier across all five conditions.

#	Cooking Tip	How To Do It & Why It Matters
1	Replace ALL Seasoning Cubes	Swap Maggi/Knorr for: fresh garlic + ginger + onions + scent leaf (efirin) + uziza + utazi. This one change reduces sodium dramatically, protecting your kidneys AND blood pressure simultaneously.
2	Leach High-Potassium Vegetables (for CKD patients)	Peel and slice ugwu, spinach, and tomatoes. Boil in water for 5 minutes. DISCARD the water. Rinse. Then use in your soup. This reduces potassium content by up to 50% — making these vegetables safer for damaged kidneys.
3	Reduce Palm Oil in ALL Soups	Limit to 1–2 tablespoons per pot (not the usual cup). Better still, switch to a small amount of vegetable oil or olive oil. Excess palm oil raises LDL cholesterol and contributes to insulin resistance.
4	Control Swallow Portions	Use a kitchen scale or compare to a tennis ball (one portion = ~150g). Oat swallow or wheat fufu in small portions is far safer than large quantities of any swallow. Large portions spike blood sugar even with 'healthier' swallows.
5	Grill, Boil, or Steam — Never Fry	Grilling tilapia, boiling chicken, or steaming Moi Moi keeps the protein intact while removing the added fat from frying. Fried foods raise LDL cholesterol and worsen insulin resistance.
6	Choose Fresh Fish Over Smoked, Dried, or Stockfish	Fresh catfish, tilapia, or croaker have a fraction of the sodium and phosphorus of their smoked or dried equivalents. Stockfish is especially harmful for kidney patients and those with hypertension.
7	Drink Your Zobo Without Sugar	Unsweetened Zobo is therapeutic — it lowers blood pressure, cholesterol, blood sugar, and helps kidneys flush uric acid. But add sugar and it becomes a high-fructose drink that triggers exactly the problems you are trying to avoid.
8	Use Lemon or Orange Juice as Natural Seasoning	Squeeze fresh lemon or orange over fish, chicken, or salads instead of salt. The citric acid adds flavour, reduces the need for sodium, AND lowers uric acid levels — perfect for gout.
9	Eat Smaller, More Frequent Meals	Instead of one large meal with a big swallow, eat 3–4 smaller portions through the day. This stabilises blood sugar, reduces the load on kidneys at any one time, and prevents large blood pressure spikes after eating.
10	Always Add Plenty of Vegetables to Your Swallow Meal	If you eat rice or any swallow, fill at least half your plate with non-starchy vegetables (cabbage, garden egg, cucumber, tatashe). This reduces the glycaemic impact of the meal and adds important fibre and vitamins.

11	Soak Dried Beans Before Cooking	Soak for 8–12 hours and change the water before cooking. This reduces phytic acid and some potassium content, making beans gentler on kidneys and easier to digest for all conditions.
12	Avoid Adding Extra Salt at the Table	A major source of excess sodium in Nigerian diets is table salt added after cooking. Remove the salt shaker from the dining table entirely. Train yourself and your household to taste first before adding anything.
13	Make Homemade Stock Instead of Bouillon Cubes	Boil chicken bones, ginger, onions, and garlic to make a low-sodium stock. Store in the fridge and use as base for all soups and stews — much safer than any commercial stock cube.
14	Limit Portion of Any Starchy Food	Even healthy starches (yam, unripe plantain, oat swallow) become harmful in large quantities for diabetics. A safe portion is the size of your fist, not a large bowl. Pair any starch with protein AND vegetables.
15	Read Food Labels When Buying Packaged Foods	Check sodium (aim < 200mg per serving), phosphorus additives (avoid any ingredient ending in '-phosphate'), and sugar content. Many 'healthy' packaged Nigerian foods are loaded with hidden sodium and phosphates harmful to kidneys.